

involuntary sepia

as i step outside, the cold
wind whips warmth
into my skin of
a place that's never
left me. but i left it,
despite the scar from the
branding iron on my heart.

the other places affirm
that they're better for me.
my friends say the same and
they're right, but when i gash
my head on the gnarled rail
of the sidewalk, and crimson trickles
from a slit in my skull, its brown
specks reveal only one type of soil.

as thebe said, *a list of the reasons
i love my mother's laugh.
the best one is that's just what it is.*
i am of it. *family* seeps into
the gaps between my ribs. *home*
is a word that makes as much
sense as liquid expanding
when it freezes. which is
to say, it doesn't. which is to say,
it does but only if it's clear and
omnipresent.